Learn About Being a DevOps Engineer

Written by Indeed Editorial Team

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Video: Becoming a DevOps Engineer

Are you interested in a career as a DevOps Engineer but are not sure how to start preparing for it? We have you covered!

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What does a DevOps engineer do?

A DevOps (development operations) engineer facilitates communication between the developmental and operational sides in software development. A DevOps engineer makes it easier for the two sides to share feedback to make a more streamlined process, which decreases the time required for development. Responsibilities that a DevOps engineer might perform include:

- Possessing a thorough understanding of the goals and responsibilities for both the development and operational teams

- Assisting in the planning and development of new coding to implement new systems
- Overseeing the release of new features from development to employees to ensure that software is reliable when cleared for use
- Monitoring the security of new builds to assess any potential holes that could lead to security threats.

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Average salary

Most DevOps engineers are typically full-time employees. Besides traditional compensation, DevOps engineers also commonly receive cash bonuses each year. The salary a DevOps engineer receives may depend on education and experience. The type, location and size of the company in which they are employed may also affect pay. For the most up-to-date salary information from Indeed, click on the salary link.

- Common salary in the U.S.: $122,973 per year
- Some salaries range from **$46,000 to $229,000 per year.**

DevOps engineer requirements

A qualified DevOps engineer candidate will show the requirements for the position, including:

Education

A DevOps engineer should have at least a bachelor's degree in computer science, computer programming or a related field in engineering. It is also useful for aspiring DevOps engineers to diversify their technical coursework as much as possible during their studies, either by pursuing a relevant minor or using general elective credits to further computer and engineering knowledge.

Some DevOps engineers pursue a master's degree in a computer science field. Earning a master's degree typically qualifies them for higher positions in industries and may increase their earning potential.

Training

To be an effective DevOps professional, you need to possess a diverse knowledge base in many technologies. DevOps professionals can receive this training by gaining experience in various technical positions. There are three main areas of training that a DevOps engineer should focus on:

- **Operating systems:** The main portion of any interactive technology is the operating system. Though they should learn iOS and Windows operating systems, a DevOps engineer should focus their training on Linux since it is an open-source system that many IT professionals use.
- **Programming:** The skill of programming refers to using back-end computer languages to create applications. There are many programming languages in use. However, the most useful language to train in for DevOps is Python. It is a versatile language that is widely used, and most employers will expect familiarity with it when seeking candidates.
- **Cloud technology:** The use of cloud technology is becoming increasingly prevalent, and a DevOps engineer needs to be familiar with different platforms. The most popular services are Azure, Google Cloud and Amazon Web Services.

Certifications

DevOps engineers can earn a variety of technical certifications that show their knowledge in a particular subject. Two popular certifications include:

Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE):

The RHCE is a senior-level certification and shows that you have advanced skills with Linux. This makes it an excellent option to stand out compared to your fellow applicants. To earn an RHCE, you must earn a Red Hat Certified System Administrator certification and pass an exam.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) DevOps Engineer-Professional certification

This certification shows your knowledge of the operations and methodologies related to AWS. To earn an AWS DevOps Engineer-Professional certification, you must pass an exam. The exam provides three hours for the test taker to answer between 40 and 65 multiple-choice questions. The exam covers a broad range of topics, including SDLC automation, incident and event response, policies and standards automation, monitoring and logging and content management and infrastructure as code.

Skills

A qualified DevOps engineer will possess both hard and soft skills:

- **Technical skills:** A DevOps engineer should be able to oversee all aspects of software development. It is essential that a candidate can show a strong understanding of all relevant tools and languages that the company uses to excel at the position.
- **Analytical ability:** An analytical ability can help a DevOps engineer understand complex situations, identify potential problems and develop effective solutions. This is a vital skill for a DevOps engineer, as it is important to the troubleshooting process of software development.
- **Problem-solving:** This skill involves finding creative ways of addressing problems a DevOps professional might encounter. One of the most crucial roles this professional performs is to identify problems in operations and work with developers to create solutions. Problem-solving skills help a DevOps engineer identify solutions quickly to ensure that the operations side of a company can resume work as soon as possible.
- **Communication:** The ability to clearly communicate with others, both verbally and in text, is an essential skill in many careers, including DevOps. A DevOps engineer requires strong communication skills to exchange information between the development and operations branches of the company.
- **Time management:** This skill allows an individual to prioritize responsibilities and plan the most efficient way to complete them to ensure they complete the most important tasks first. A DevOps manager often has many responsibilities and it's necessary to prioritize them correctly.

Read more: Essential DevOps Engineer Skills for Job Seekers

DevOps engineer work environment

Most DevOps engineers work in office settings in situations that include:

- Hosting meetings of the development team to outline current goals and new design features
- Speaking with employees from the operations side of the company to assess the performance of software and identify areas for improvement
- Working at a computer to assist in the coding and development process

DevOps engineers can find employment in a variety of industries, such as:

- Government
- Software development
- Education

- Nonprofit organizations
- Corporations
- Healthcare

How to become a DevOps engineer

You can follow these steps to become a DevOps engineer:

1. Earn a degree.

The first step toward a career as a DevOps engineer is completing an undergraduate degree in computer science, computer programming or engineering field. You may also earn a master's degree. It's helpful to review requirements for different DevOps positions in your location to determine what level of education you may need.

2. Gain relevant experience.

DevOps is a senior-level career in technology. Aspiring DevOps engineers need to first begin with entry-level positions, such as IT support specialists or IT technicians. After gaining experience in an entry-level role, you can apply for higher-level positions that require more knowledge. You can also seek management roles to earn valuable leadership experience.

3. Get certified.

Certifications not only show your knowledge but also set you apart from applicants. A diversified set of certifications covering the many facets of a DevOps engineer's responsibilities is ideal. Consider earning common certifications that many employers seek.

4. Create a resume.

Craft your resume to highlight your experience and skills to prospective employers. List your jobs from most to least recent, and list any achievement that could relate to a position in DevOps. Include any active certifications and transferable skills you possess.

5. Apply for openings.

Search for DevOps engineer postings listing requirements that align with your experience. Consider submitting a cover letter that further shows your capabilities for a DevOps role. If you work for a company that has DevOps positions, you may apply for a promotion. Ask your manager or Human Resources department if any openings relate to your current experience level in DevOps.

DevOps engineer job description example

We are seeking an experienced DevOps engineer to join our team of innovators. The DevOps engineer will be responsible for facilitating efficient communication between the development team and operations to increase production speed, as well as assisting in the development of code for new software. The ideal candidate will be familiar with Linux, Python and AWS. Candidates should also have experience in a leadership role, with at least three years as a manager in a tech-related field. Please include a cover letter and recommendation from a former manager in a tech job.



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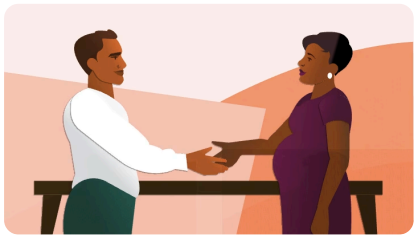
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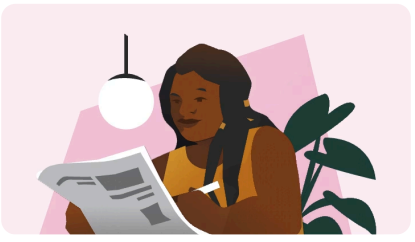
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